



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Legacy Christian Academy  
School Website: <https://www.legacybranson.com>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

Legacy Branson Academy (Legacy Academy Branson, MO) presents a cohesive Classical Christian program that aligns with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books and the Great Conversation, formation of virtue and character, and a robust partnership with families in a liturgical, Christ-centered community. The school explicitly anchors education in theology and Scripture, integrates chapels and daily devotionals, and foregrounds both memory-led pedagogy in the grammar stage and Socratic/seminar-style discourse in the upper grades. The faculty are described as mentors and living embodiments of the school's aims, with accreditation through ACCS and a stated mission to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty in students. Parental involvement is positioned as central, with a formal emphasis on parents as co-educators and a culture of family partnership.

Category-by-category results (based on keyword analysis against the Positive/Negative Keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Key insights: - The program consistently treats education as formation—virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent order (truth, goodness, beauty) are presented as real and knowable, not merely instrumental. - The curriculum centers the Trivium and Great Books, with explicit attention to memory, repetition, and classical discipline across K–12. - Pedagogy blends contemplative, ritual, and communal practices (prayer/chapel) with Socratic, seminar-style inquiry and rhetorical training. - The school frames the faculty as living mentors and the parents as co-educators, with explicit structures for parent involvement and ongoing formation.

What would move the needle - No major needle-moving changes are required; the school already demonstrates full CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. If desired, future refinements could emphasize even more explicit “great conversation” participation through additional co-curricular Great Books programs or broaden the public articulation of the faculty-as-living-curriculum concept to include teacher portraits and professional formation pathways.

Abstract: The Legacy Branson site demonstrates a fully Classical framework across all six classical categories: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school models transcendental purposes (truth, goodness, beauty) within a robust Trivium-based curriculum, integrates Great Books and the Great Conversation, employs a balance of contemplative and Socratic pedagogy, presents teachers as living exemplars, and treats parents as essential partners in a formation-oriented education.

## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as Classical Christian and explicitly connects education to Christ-centered formation and Scripture (gospel integration across subjects) and daily spiritual practices. See statements about integrating Scripture and daily devotionals, and the Christ-centered framework described in leadership and pedagogy materials. - Public materials note liturgical/community practices (chapels, daily prayer, devotionals) as part of the school culture. - The “Portrait of a Graduate” emphasizes forming students as Christ-followers with virtues aligned to Christian orthodoxy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Christ, gospel, Scripture/Bible, daily prayer, devotionals, chapel, Word of God, Christian faith, liturgical integration, gospel-centered mission. These terms appear throughout the published pages described above. - Negative keywords observed: None in the public materials (no prominent secular or anti-theological framing). The materials consistently foreground theology and worship-related terms.

Why this rating - The materials consistently ground education in theology, liturgical practice, and communal worship, and the mission emphasizes a theologically grounded formation of character and intellect. This aligns squarely with the Classical School criterion for a grounded religious/metaphysical foundation.

---

### Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere job preparation. The mission centers on cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty within human flourishing, with explicit language about forming affections toward classical ends. - The school describes itself as forming “truth-grounded, spiritually-formed, and culturally-transforming Christ followers,” emphasizing moral and intellectual formation over vocational metrics. - The “Portrait of a Graduate” emphasizes a mind/heart formation—truth, goodness, beauty—grounded in Christian truth.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, character, mind of Christ, virtue formation, moral imagination, flourishing. These terms appear across mission statements and outcome descriptions. - Negative keywords observed: None indicating a primary focus on job placement or purely information-transfer goals; the content consistently centers on formation and transcendent aims.

Why this rating - Formation-centered aims focusing on virtue, wisdom, and permanence (truth/goodness/beauty) align with the Classical rubric for School Purpose and Goal.

---

### Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) is highlighted as a foundational framework (grammar in K–5, logic in middle school, rhetoric in upper grades). - Great Books and the Great Conversation are explicitly mentioned as part of the curriculum and worldview education. - Latin instruction is integrated in the grammar/early logic phases, with a focus on classical languages and a global/world-history sequence (Ancient, Medieval, Renaissance, Modern) in the Grammar School. - History is studied across the curriculum (global/world history in sequence) rather than relegated to a single social studies course, and the curriculum emphasizes a core knowledge sequence in History, Science, Literature, Art, and Music. - The school emphasizes “Great Books” and engaging with primary sources/Great Conversation as a core experience.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, Great Conversation, memory/recall, Latin, history/science integrated, classical languages, primary sources, formation through the liberal arts. - Negative keywords observed:

None relevant to curriculum that would undermine classical aims (e.g., “workforce prep” or “skills-first” without formation). The site emphasizes liberal arts and canon study.

Why this rating - The explicit use of Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, and an integrated history sequence across the curriculum marks the school as CLASSICAL in curriculum design.

---

#### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Grammar-stage pedagogy emphasizes singing, memory, recitation, and multisensory learning (memory-anchored and chant-based methods). - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, alongside opportunities for public speaking and senior-level theses. - A multi-modal approach (visual, auditory, kinesthetic learning) is described as accommodating various learner strengths, with a focus on gentle review and memorization as well as rigorous argumentation in higher grades. - The program includes daily devotionals, chapels, and faith-integrated instruction, aligning pedagogy with religious formation. In higher grades, there is explicit emphasis on logic, rhetoric, and research-based writing, including primary sources.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: singing/recitation, memory, schemata for memorization, chanting, Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric training, thesis, primary-source analysis, logic, memory-based pedagogy, teacher as mentor. - Negative keywords observed: None indicating non-classical methods (e.g., pure project-based without classical scaffolding); the materials emphasize classical stages (grammar–logic–rhetoric) with associated methods.

Why this rating - The pedagogy aligns with CLASSICAL expectations: contemplative/restful elements in early years, memory-focused grammar instruction, Socratic seminars, and rhetoric-oriented performance in upper grades.

---

#### **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The materials describe teachers as mentors who model virtue and operate as the core of the school (the “living curriculum”). They are presented as guardians of the school’s mission and as collaborative colleagues within a virtuous culture. - The school describes staff as shepherding students, integrating gospel into all disciplines, and reciting material to connect content to faith, suggesting a teacher-centered, virtue-forming leadership role. - The school presents a portrait of the teacher as a model of virtue and a partner in the formation of students, with a structured expectations framework for both teacher and student conduct.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, virtuous scholars, teacher as guide/partner, classical teacher formation, intellectual virtue, mentorship, Christian vocation of teaching. - Negative keywords observed: None indicating a de-emphasis on teacher role or a purely technocratic staff model.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials position faculty as central to the school’s mission and as active agents in forming character and intellect, meeting CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.

---

#### **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school foregrounds partnership with families as co-educators, with explicit language about parental engagement, home-school collaboration, and family formation as part of the classical project. - Parent formation is supported by resources on the site (articles, book studies) and invitations for parental involvement through events, gatherings, and parent councils. The site frames education as a joint enterprise between school and family. - The school notes that parents are welcome for visits at virtually any time and emphasizes a community culture that integrates family life with school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent as co-teachers, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, parent formation, family catechesis, community of learners, visiting parents, parent councils. - Negative keywords observed: None indicating distancing from families; the materials consistently endorse family involvement.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates explicit, ongoing parent-partnership structures and materials aimed at educating parents about classical education, which is a hallmark of CLASSICAL community practice.

---

### What Would Move the Needle

- The school already attains CLASSICAL status across all six categories. No major needle-moving changes are required to reach full CLASSICAL alignment. If desired, incremental steps could include:
  - Publish a concise, public-facing pledge or “living curriculum” descriptor that explicitly maps each element of the Trivium/Quadrivium to concrete courses and assessments per grade.
  - Expand teacher portraits or profiles to further illustrate how the faculty embody the living curriculum and virtuous formation in practice.
  - Add more explicit parent education resources or community reading groups around the Great Books and classical pedagogy to deepen parent formation beyond the current resources.
-

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.